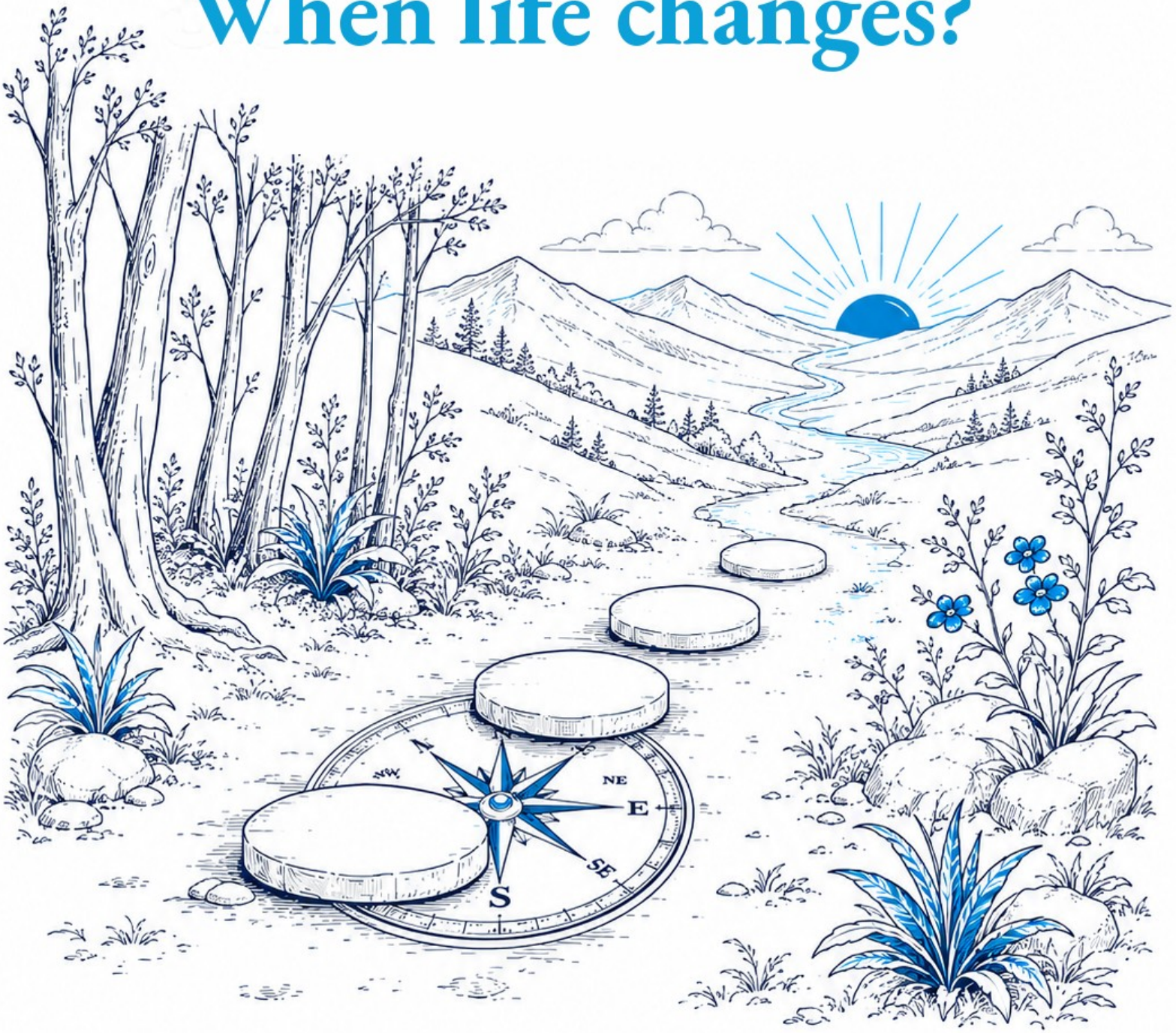
BOUNCING FORWARD

What's your next move...

When life changes?



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How to use it

Keep it near the kettle, not in a drawer. The reset on page 6 is the page to read on a bad morning. The four compass questions on page 10 are for Sunday evenings. The number on page 9 is for once a week, honestly. Everything else is there for when you have the capacity for it.

A note from Maher

Thank you for giving an hour to this. I know what an hour costs when your plans have just come apart.

Bouncing Forward began with the worst day of my life. In January 2008 my son Hikmat was seventeen when a car struck him in Amman and the driver drove on. For a long time there was nothing beside that fact. Then a question appeared: what happens next? Over time that question changed shape into a better one, and it is the question I would like you to keep: not why is this happening to me, but what does this ask of me?

Your setback and mine are different, and I would never pretend otherwise. But the question works the same way for both. It takes your attention off what cannot be changed and puts it on the next move. Everything in the webinar, and everything in these pages, is built to help you find that move and take it.

You will notice there is no instruction here to think positively or to put it behind you. What I hope you take from this is permission: to look honestly at what has changed, to draw a line between what is settled and what is still yours, and to take one small step in a direction you have chosen.

The direction matters more than the scale. One conversation, one application, one step, repeated, is how a life changes. It is how mine did.

Go well, and keep bouncing forward.

Maher Kaddoura
Author of Bouncing Forward

What you wrote in the webinar

Every question from the hour, in the order we asked them. Copy across what you wrote on the day, or write it again now that the dust has settled.

1 Where am I now?

Where am I now? One honest sentence: what changed, and where I really am today

How equipped do I feel, today, to deal with this? Tick or colour in. One is hardly at all; five is completely.

1	2	3	4	5

2 One word for what changed my plan

Health, money, career, relationship, family, loss, business, age, or your own word.

3 The Control Line

Left: the facts. Right: my response, who I talk to, what I learn, what I try next, the help I ask for. Circle one thing on the right.

What is already true and can't be changed	What is still in my hands
1.	1.
2.	2.
3.	3.
4.	4.
5.	5.
6.	6.

4 What now matters?

Research shows that growth after a setback shows up in five areas: relationships, new possibilities, your own strength, what matters, and appreciation of life.

What matters more now?

What matters less now?

What have I learned about myself?

5 What carried me through the last hard thing

One word, or one name. Something inside you, or someone around you. It is still there.

6 Six months from now, I would like

One concrete thing. Small and true beats big and borrowed. Whose face is attached to this?

7 Why this matters, because

The reason, rather than the goal. This is the line to read on a bad morning.

8 My 24-hour move

Ten minutes or less to do. Anything bigger is a project, and projects can wait. A step with a witness is a different kind of commitment.

My direction

The smallest real step towards it, within 24 hours

Day: _____ Time: _____ Witness (first name): _____

Your five-sentence reset

The whole path in your own handwriting. Five sentences, ten minutes. This is the page to come back to the next time life changes the plan.

1 The plan that changed was

Accept. Where you are, honestly.

2 What is settled is, and what I can still influence is

Accept. The Control Line.

3 What this asks of me is

Reflect. Maher's question.

4 Six months from now, I would like

Imagine. One direction, with a reason.

5 Within the next twenty-four hours, I will

Action. The smallest real step, with a witness.

Photograph this page and keep it on your phone.

The webinar in two pages



Plans change

Jobs change, relationships change, businesses change, bodies change. So the real question is less 'will my plan change?' and more 'what's my next move when it does?'



One event, two losses

The first loss is what happened, and everyone can see it. The second is the future you had pictured, invisible to everyone else. Simply naming it makes it lighter.



Acceptance is a bridge

What happened is on one bank and your next move is on the other. Accepting means being accurate rather than agreeing. You can dislike the river and still cross it.



What does this ask of me?

Reflection moves you along, while going round in circles brings you back to the start. When the road closes, ask what this asks of you from exactly where you are.



This wasn't the plan

Whatever your version, it starts the day the ground shifts. Every setback counts: the details may differ, but the feeling of the ground shifting is the same.



Where am I now?

Honesty is dropping the pin: one plain sentence about what changed and where you really are today, and a number from one to five for how ready you feel.



Draw the Control Line

On the left, what is already settled. On the right, what is still in your hands: how you respond, who you talk to, what you try next. Circle one thing to carry forward.



What matters more or less now?

What matters more now, what matters less, and what have I learned about myself? Many people grow after big changes, with clearer priorities and a stronger sense of what they can handle.



Resilience: bending is not breaking

Bamboo bends almost flat in a storm and stands straight back up when the wind drops. People adapt to big changes far better and faster than they expect.



Support: built in quiet seasons

A support net is built with every call you return and every small kindness. If yours feels thin, see that as information rather than a verdict.



A direction is enough

Leave the five-year plan for later. What you need now is a direction: one honest sentence about what you would like to be different. Maher calls it purpose before plans.



Six months from now

One concrete thing, honest rather than impressive. Small and true beats big and borrowed. Then add your reason: why does this matter to me? Because...



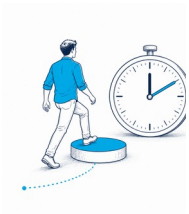
Optimism. The real kind.

Real optimism is quieter than a big smile. It simply keeps the door open, whether you feel hopeful on the day or not.



The 24-hour move

The smallest real step you can take within twenty-four hours. Ten minutes or less, starting with a verb: call, send, walk, book, ask. Add a day, a time and a witness.



The smallest real step

The step comes first and the plan takes shape behind it. Maher's first step was a newspaper and a piece of paper, counting the accidents on Jordan's roads.



Adaptability: keep the direction

When life answers with a twist, recalculate like a GPS. Change how you get there, and keep heading the same way.



Your road map

The path is what you do; the compass is what you draw on. Resilience, support, optimism and adaptability: four strengths you already carry into your next move.

Seven days of small steps

One small step a day. No catching up, no perfect streak. Just the next one.

Day 1	**Take your 24-hour move.** Then tell your witness you did it.	What I did
Day 2	**Add one thing to the right-hand column.** Something still in your hands that you had been treating as fixed.	What I did
Day 3	**Reread your six-month sentence.** Make it smaller, or make it truer.	What I did
Day 4	**Ask one person for one specific thing.** Say what, by when, and for how long.	What I did
Day 5	**Notice one what-if and stop it at twenty minutes.** Write down where it took you. Probably nowhere new.	What I did
Day 6	**Take the next smallest step.** Same direction. Ten minutes or less.	What I did
Day 7	**Review.** Take your number again below. What moved?	What I did

Where am I now? Again.

Once a week, honestly. One means hardly equipped at all; five means completely. The number is evidence, and evidence is what resilience runs on.

Date	How equipped do I feel? (1 to 5)	What moved this week

For the bad morning

The morning when 'I will' has nothing left in it. Read your reason first, then write.

My reason, because

What this is asking of me today

The smallest real step I can take today, and who will know

For the Sunday evening

When the week ahead feels heavy, check your compass. One line each. Then one step.

Resilience: what have I come through before?

Support: who can I let in?

Optimism: what's still working?

Adaptability: what can I change about how I get there?

One step this week, with a day, a time and a witness

Everything on bouncing-forward.com is free: the first chapter of Maher's book, the stories of people who have bounced forward, and a two-minute check that gives you your compass reading today.

Setbacks don't get the last word.